



VOLUME 02

REFLECTION, SERIALIZATION AND OBJECT MODEL

Generated reflection, metadata, object handles, archives, schema evolution, transactions, prefabs and persistence contracts.

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02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Purpose and boundary: editor needs

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to editor needs. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Editor needs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with script needs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for editor needs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep script needs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and editor needs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Architecture: script needs

This page defines the architecture for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to script needs. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Script needs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with serialization needs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for script needs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep serialization needs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and script needs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Data model: serialization needs

This page defines the data model for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to serialization needs. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Serialization needs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin needs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for serialization needs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin needs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and serialization needs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Public API: plugin needs

This page defines the public api for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to plugin needs. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Plugin needs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with no unrestricted RTTI is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for plugin needs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep no unrestricted RTTI behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and plugin needs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Ownership and lifetime: no unrestricted RTTI

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to no unrestricted RTTI. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

No unrestricted rtti is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with editor needs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for no unrestricted RTTI; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep editor needs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and no unrestricted RTTI.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Threading model: editor needs

This page defines the threading model for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to editor needs. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Editor needs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with script needs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for editor needs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep script needs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and editor needs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Memory strategy: script needs

This page defines the memory strategy for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to script needs. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Script needs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with serialization needs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for script needs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep serialization needs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and script needs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.01 Reflection goals and non-goals

Failure handling: serialization needs

This page defines the failure handling for Reflection goals and non-goals, with particular attention to serialization needs. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Serialization needs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin needs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for serialization needs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin needs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.01 and serialization needs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Purpose and boundary: annotations

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to annotations. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Annotations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with macros versus attributes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for annotations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep macros versus attributes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class MetadataDeclarationSyntaxService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const MetadataDeclarationSyntaxConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    MetadataDeclarationSyntaxState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and annotations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Architecture: macros versus attributes

This page defines the architecture for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to macros versus attributes. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Macros versus attributes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generated headers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for macros versus attributes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generated headers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Metadata", "MetadataDeclarationSyntax");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and macros versus attributes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Data model: generated headers

This page defines the data model for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to generated headers. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Generated headers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with source locations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for generated headers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep source locations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class MetadataDeclarationSyntaxService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const MetadataDeclarationSyntaxConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    MetadataDeclarationSyntaxState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and generated headers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Public API: source locations

This page defines the public api for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to source locations. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Source locations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with diagnostics is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for source locations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep diagnostics behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Metadata", "MetadataDeclarationSyntax");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and source locations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Ownership and lifetime: diagnostics

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to diagnostics. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Diagnostics is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with annotations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for diagnostics; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep annotations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class MetadataDeclarationSyntaxService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const MetadataDeclarationSyntaxConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    MetadataDeclarationSyntaxState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and diagnostics.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Threading model: annotations

This page defines the threading model for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to annotations. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Annotations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with macros versus attributes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for annotations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep macros versus attributes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Metadata", "MetadataDeclarationSyntax");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and annotations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Memory strategy: macros versus attributes

This page defines the memory strategy for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to macros versus attributes. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Macros versus attributes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generated headers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for macros versus attributes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generated headers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class MetadataDeclarationSyntaxService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const MetadataDeclarationSyntaxConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    MetadataDeclarationSyntaxState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and macros versus attributes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Failure handling: generated headers

This page defines the failure handling for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to generated headers. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Generated headers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with source locations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for generated headers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep source locations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Metadata", "MetadataDeclarationSyntax");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and generated headers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Diagnostics: source locations

This page defines the diagnostics for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to source locations. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Source locations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with diagnostics is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for source locations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep diagnostics behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class MetadataDeclarationSyntaxService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const MetadataDeclarationSyntaxConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    MetadataDeclarationSyntaxState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and source locations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Implementation sequence: diagnostics

This page defines the implementation sequence for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to diagnostics. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Diagnostics is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with annotations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for diagnostics; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep annotations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Metadata", "MetadataDeclarationSyntax");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and diagnostics.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Verification: annotations

This page defines the verification for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to annotations. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Annotations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with macros versus attributes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for annotations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep macros versus attributes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class MetadataDeclarationSyntaxService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const MetadataDeclarationSyntaxConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    MetadataDeclarationSyntaxState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and annotations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.02 Metadata declaration syntax

Completion gate: macros versus attributes

This page defines the completion gate for Metadata declaration syntax, with particular attention to macros versus attributes. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Macros versus attributes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generated headers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for macros versus attributes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generated headers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Metadata", "MetadataDeclarationSyntax");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.02 and macros versus attributes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Purpose and boundary: scanner

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to scanner. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Scanner is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with AST extraction is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for scanner; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep AST extraction behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and scanner.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Architecture: AST extraction

This page defines the architecture for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to AST extraction. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Ast extraction is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with incremental generation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for AST extraction; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep incremental generation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and AST extraction.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Data model: incremental generation

This page defines the data model for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to incremental generation. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Incremental generation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with CMake hooks is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for incremental generation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep CMake hooks behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and incremental generation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Public API: CMake hooks

This page defines the public api for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to CMake hooks. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Cmake hooks is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deterministic output is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for CMake hooks; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deterministic output behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and CMake hooks.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Ownership and lifetime: deterministic output

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to deterministic output. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Deterministic output is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with scanner is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deterministic output; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep scanner behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and deterministic output.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Threading model: scanner

This page defines the threading model for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to scanner. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Scanner is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with AST extraction is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for scanner; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep AST extraction behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and scanner.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Memory strategy: AST extraction

This page defines the memory strategy for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to AST extraction. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Ast extraction is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with incremental generation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for AST extraction; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep incremental generation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and AST extraction.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Failure handling: incremental generation

This page defines the failure handling for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to incremental generation. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Incremental generation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with CMake hooks is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for incremental generation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep CMake hooks behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and incremental generation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Diagnostics: CMake hooks

This page defines the diagnostics for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to CMake hooks. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Cmake hooks is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deterministic output is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for CMake hooks; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deterministic output behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and CMake hooks.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Implementation sequence: deterministic output

This page defines the implementation sequence for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to deterministic output. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Deterministic output is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with scanner is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deterministic output; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep scanner behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and deterministic output.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Verification: scanner

This page defines the verification for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to scanner. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Scanner is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with AST extraction is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for scanner; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep AST extraction behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and scanner.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Completion gate: AST extraction

This page defines the completion gate for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to AST extraction. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Ast extraction is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with incremental generation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for AST extraction; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep incremental generation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and AST extraction.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Purpose and boundary: incremental generation

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to incremental generation. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Incremental generation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with CMake hooks is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for incremental generation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep CMake hooks behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and incremental generation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Architecture: CMake hooks

This page defines the architecture for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to CMake hooks. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Cmake hooks is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deterministic output is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for CMake hooks; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deterministic output behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and CMake hooks.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Data model: deterministic output

This page defines the data model for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to deterministic output. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Deterministic output is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with scanner is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deterministic output; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep scanner behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and deterministic output.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Public API: scanner

This page defines the public api for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to scanner. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Scanner is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with AST extraction is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for scanner; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep AST extraction behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reflection", "ReflectionCodeGenerator");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and scanner.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.03 Reflection code generator

Ownership and lifetime: AST extraction

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Reflection code generator, with particular attention to AST extraction. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Ast extraction is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with incremental generation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for AST extraction; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep incremental generation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReflectionCodeGeneratorService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReflectionCodeGeneratorConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReflectionCodeGeneratorState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.03 and AST extraction.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Purpose and boundary: registration

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to registration. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Registration is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with module ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for registration; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep module ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TypeRegistryAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TypeRegistryAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TypeRegistryAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and registration.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Architecture: module ownership

This page defines the architecture for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to module ownership. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Module ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inheritance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for module ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inheritance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Type", "TypeRegistryAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and module ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Data model: inheritance

This page defines the data model for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to inheritance. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Inheritance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with interfaces is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for inheritance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep interfaces behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TypeRegistryAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TypeRegistryAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TypeRegistryAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and inheritance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Public API: interfaces

This page defines the public api for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to interfaces. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Interfaces is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hot reload conflicts is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for interfaces; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hot reload conflicts behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Type", "TypeRegistryAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and interfaces.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Ownership and lifetime: hot reload conflicts

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to hot reload conflicts. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Hot reload conflicts is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with registration is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for hot reload conflicts; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep registration behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TypeRegistryAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TypeRegistryAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TypeRegistryAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and hot reload conflicts.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Threading model: registration

This page defines the threading model for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to registration. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Registration is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with module ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for registration; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep module ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Type", "TypeRegistryAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and registration.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Memory strategy: module ownership

This page defines the memory strategy for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to module ownership. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Module ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inheritance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for module ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inheritance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TypeRegistryAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TypeRegistryAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TypeRegistryAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and module ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Failure handling: inheritance

This page defines the failure handling for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to inheritance. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Inheritance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with interfaces is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for inheritance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep interfaces behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Type", "TypeRegistryAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and inheritance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Diagnostics: interfaces

This page defines the diagnostics for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to interfaces. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Interfaces is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hot reload conflicts is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for interfaces; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hot reload conflicts behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TypeRegistryAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TypeRegistryAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TypeRegistryAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and interfaces.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Implementation sequence: hot reload conflicts

This page defines the implementation sequence for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to hot reload conflicts. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Hot reload conflicts is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with registration is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for hot reload conflicts; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep registration behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Type", "TypeRegistryAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and hot reload conflicts.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Verification: registration

This page defines the verification for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to registration. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Registration is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with module ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for registration; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep module ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TypeRegistryAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TypeRegistryAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TypeRegistryAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and registration.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Completion gate: module ownership

This page defines the completion gate for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to module ownership. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Module ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inheritance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for module ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inheritance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Type", "TypeRegistryAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and module ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Purpose and boundary: inheritance

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to inheritance. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Inheritance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with interfaces is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for inheritance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep interfaces behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TypeRegistryAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TypeRegistryAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TypeRegistryAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and inheritance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.04 Type registry and stable type IDs

Architecture: interfaces

This page defines the architecture for Type registry and stable type IDs, with particular attention to interfaces. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Interfaces is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hot reload conflicts is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for interfaces; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hot reload conflicts behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Type", "TypeRegistryAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.04 and interfaces.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Purpose and boundary: accessors

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to accessors. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Accessors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with attributes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for accessors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep attributes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PropertyAndFunctionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PropertyAndFunctionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PropertyAndFunctionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and accessors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Architecture: attributes

This page defines the architecture for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to attributes. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Attributes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with ranges is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for attributes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep ranges behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Property", "PropertyAndFunction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and attributes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Data model: ranges

This page defines the data model for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to ranges. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Ranges is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with defaults is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for ranges; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep defaults behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PropertyAndFunctionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PropertyAndFunctionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PropertyAndFunctionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and ranges.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Public API: defaults

This page defines the public api for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to defaults. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Defaults is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with editor flags is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for defaults; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep editor flags behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Property", "PropertyAndFunction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and defaults.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Ownership and lifetime: editor flags

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to editor flags. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Editor flags is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with script exposure is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for editor flags; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep script exposure behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PropertyAndFunctionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PropertyAndFunctionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PropertyAndFunctionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and editor flags.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Threading model: script exposure

This page defines the threading model for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to script exposure. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Script exposure is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with accessors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for script exposure; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep accessors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Property", "PropertyAndFunction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and script exposure.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Memory strategy: accessors

This page defines the memory strategy for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to accessors. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Accessors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with attributes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for accessors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep attributes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PropertyAndFunctionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PropertyAndFunctionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PropertyAndFunctionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and accessors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Failure handling: attributes

This page defines the failure handling for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to attributes. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Attributes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with ranges is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for attributes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep ranges behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Property", "PropertyAndFunction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and attributes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Diagnostics: ranges

This page defines the diagnostics for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to ranges. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Ranges is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with defaults is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for ranges; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep defaults behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PropertyAndFunctionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PropertyAndFunctionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PropertyAndFunctionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and ranges.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Implementation sequence: defaults

This page defines the implementation sequence for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to defaults. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Defaults is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with editor flags is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for defaults; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep editor flags behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Property", "PropertyAndFunction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and defaults.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Verification: editor flags

This page defines the verification for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to editor flags. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Editor flags is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with script exposure is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for editor flags; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep script exposure behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PropertyAndFunctionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PropertyAndFunctionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PropertyAndFunctionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and editor flags.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Completion gate: script exposure

This page defines the completion gate for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to script exposure. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Script exposure is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with accessors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for script exposure; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep accessors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Property", "PropertyAndFunction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and script exposure.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.05 Property and function descriptors

Purpose and boundary: accessors

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Property and function descriptors, with particular attention to accessors. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Accessors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with attributes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for accessors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep attributes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PropertyAndFunctionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PropertyAndFunctionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PropertyAndFunctionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.05 and accessors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Purpose and boundary: generation handles

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to generation handles. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Generation handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with weak handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for generation handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep weak handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and generation handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Architecture: weak handles

This page defines the architecture for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to weak handles. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Weak handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deferred destruction is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for weak handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deferred destruction behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Object", "ObjectHandlesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and weak handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Data model: deferred destruction

This page defines the data model for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to deferred destruction. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Deferred destruction is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object registry is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deferred destruction; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object registry behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and deferred destruction.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Public API: object registry

This page defines the public api for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to object registry. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Object registry is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread rules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object registry; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread rules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Object", "ObjectHandlesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and object registry.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Ownership and lifetime: thread rules

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to thread rules. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Thread rules is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generation handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for thread rules; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generation handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and thread rules.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Threading model: generation handles

This page defines the threading model for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to generation handles. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Generation handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with weak handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for generation handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep weak handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Object", "ObjectHandlesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and generation handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Memory strategy: weak handles

This page defines the memory strategy for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to weak handles. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Weak handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deferred destruction is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for weak handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deferred destruction behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and weak handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Failure handling: deferred destruction

This page defines the failure handling for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to deferred destruction. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Deferred destruction is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object registry is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deferred destruction; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object registry behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Object", "ObjectHandlesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and deferred destruction.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Diagnostics: object registry

This page defines the diagnostics for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to object registry. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Object registry is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread rules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object registry; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread rules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and object registry.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Implementation sequence: thread rules

This page defines the implementation sequence for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to thread rules. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Thread rules is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generation handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for thread rules; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generation handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Object", "ObjectHandlesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and thread rules.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Verification: generation handles

This page defines the verification for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to generation handles. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Generation handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with weak handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for generation handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep weak handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and generation handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Completion gate: weak handles

This page defines the completion gate for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to weak handles. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Weak handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deferred destruction is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for weak handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deferred destruction behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Object", "ObjectHandlesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and weak handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Purpose and boundary: deferred destruction

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to deferred destruction. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Deferred destruction is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object registry is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deferred destruction; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object registry behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and deferred destruction.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Architecture: object registry

This page defines the architecture for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to object registry. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Object registry is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread rules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object registry; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread rules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Object", "ObjectHandlesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and object registry.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.06 Object handles and lifetime tracking

Data model: thread rules

This page defines the data model for Object handles and lifetime tracking, with particular attention to thread rules. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Thread rules is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generation handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for thread rules; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generation handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ObjectHandlesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ObjectHandlesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ObjectHandlesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.06 and thread rules.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Purpose and boundary: reader/writer

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to reader/writer. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Reader/writer is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with binary/text is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for reader/writer; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep binary/text behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ArchiveAbstractionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ArchiveAbstractionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ArchiveAbstractionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and reader/writer.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Architecture: binary/text

This page defines the architecture for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to binary/text. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Binary/text is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with endianness is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for binary/text; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep endianness behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Archive", "ArchiveAbstraction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and binary/text.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Data model: endianness

This page defines the data model for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to endianness. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Endianness is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with limits is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for endianness; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep limits behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ArchiveAbstractionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ArchiveAbstractionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ArchiveAbstractionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and endianness.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Public API: limits

This page defines the public api for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to limits. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Limits is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with error propagation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for limits; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep error propagation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Archive", "ArchiveAbstraction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and limits.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Ownership and lifetime: error propagation

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to error propagation. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Error propagation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with reader/writer is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for error propagation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep reader/writer behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ArchiveAbstractionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ArchiveAbstractionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ArchiveAbstractionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and error propagation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Threading model: reader/writer

This page defines the threading model for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to reader/writer. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Reader/writer is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with binary/text is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for reader/writer; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep binary/text behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Archive", "ArchiveAbstraction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and reader/writer.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Memory strategy: binary/text

This page defines the memory strategy for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to binary/text. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Binary/text is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with endianness is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for binary/text; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep endianness behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ArchiveAbstractionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ArchiveAbstractionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ArchiveAbstractionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and binary/text.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Failure handling: endianness

This page defines the failure handling for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to endianness. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Endianness is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with limits is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for endianness; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep limits behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Archive", "ArchiveAbstraction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and endianness.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Diagnostics: limits

This page defines the diagnostics for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to limits. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Limits is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with error propagation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for limits; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep error propagation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ArchiveAbstractionService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ArchiveAbstractionConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ArchiveAbstractionState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and limits.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.07 Archive abstraction

Implementation sequence: error propagation

This page defines the implementation sequence for Archive abstraction, with particular attention to error propagation. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Error propagation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with reader/writer is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for error propagation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep reader/writer behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Archive", "ArchiveAbstraction");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.07 and error propagation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Purpose and boundary: headers

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to headers. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Headers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with type tables is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for headers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep type tables behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BinarySerializationFormatService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BinarySerializationFormatConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BinarySerializationFormatState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and headers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Architecture: type tables

This page defines the architecture for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to type tables. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Type tables is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with field IDs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for type tables; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep field IDs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Binary", "BinarySerializationFormat");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and type tables.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Data model: field IDs

This page defines the data model for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to field IDs. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Field ids is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with compression hooks is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for field IDs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep compression hooks behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BinarySerializationFormatService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BinarySerializationFormatConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BinarySerializationFormatState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and field IDs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Public API: compression hooks

This page defines the public api for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to compression hooks. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Compression hooks is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with checksums is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compression hooks; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep checksums behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Binary", "BinarySerializationFormat");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and compression hooks.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Ownership and lifetime: checksums

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to checksums. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Checksums is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with unknown fields is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for checksums; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep unknown fields behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BinarySerializationFormatService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BinarySerializationFormatConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BinarySerializationFormatState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and checksums.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Threading model: unknown fields

This page defines the threading model for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to unknown fields. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Unknown fields is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with headers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for unknown fields; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep headers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Binary", "BinarySerializationFormat");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and unknown fields.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Memory strategy: headers

This page defines the memory strategy for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to headers. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Headers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with type tables is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for headers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep type tables behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BinarySerializationFormatService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BinarySerializationFormatConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BinarySerializationFormatState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and headers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Failure handling: type tables

This page defines the failure handling for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to type tables. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Type tables is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with field IDs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for type tables; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep field IDs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Binary", "BinarySerializationFormat");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and type tables.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Diagnostics: field IDs

This page defines the diagnostics for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to field IDs. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Field ids is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with compression hooks is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for field IDs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep compression hooks behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BinarySerializationFormatService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BinarySerializationFormatConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BinarySerializationFormatState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and field IDs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Implementation sequence: compression hooks

This page defines the implementation sequence for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to compression hooks. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Compression hooks is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with checksums is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compression hooks; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep checksums behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Binary", "BinarySerializationFormat");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and compression hooks.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Verification: checksums

This page defines the verification for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to checksums. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Checksums is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with unknown fields is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for checksums; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep unknown fields behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BinarySerializationFormatService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BinarySerializationFormatConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BinarySerializationFormatState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and checksums.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Completion gate: unknown fields

This page defines the completion gate for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to unknown fields. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Unknown fields is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with headers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for unknown fields; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep headers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Binary", "BinarySerializationFormat");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and unknown fields.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.08 Binary serialization format

Purpose and boundary: headers

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Binary serialization format, with particular attention to headers. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Headers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with type tables is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for headers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep type tables behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BinarySerializationFormatService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BinarySerializationFormatConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BinarySerializationFormatState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.08 and headers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Purpose and boundary: diff friendliness

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to diff friendliness. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Diff friendliness is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with canonical ordering is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for diff friendliness; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep canonical ordering behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HumanReadableProjectService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HumanReadableProjectConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HumanReadableProjectState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and diff friendliness.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Architecture: canonical ordering

This page defines the architecture for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to canonical ordering. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Canonical ordering is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with comments policy is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for canonical ordering; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep comments policy behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Human", "HumanReadableProject");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and canonical ordering.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Data model: comments policy

This page defines the data model for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to comments policy. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Comments policy is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with round trips is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for comments policy; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep round trips behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HumanReadableProjectService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HumanReadableProjectConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HumanReadableProjectState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and comments policy.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Public API: round trips

This page defines the public api for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to round trips. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Round trips is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with diff friendliness is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for round trips; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep diff friendliness behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Human", "HumanReadableProject");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and round trips.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Ownership and lifetime: diff friendliness

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to diff friendliness. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Diff friendliness is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with canonical ordering is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for diff friendliness; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep canonical ordering behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HumanReadableProjectService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HumanReadableProjectConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HumanReadableProjectState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and diff friendliness.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Threading model: canonical ordering

This page defines the threading model for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to canonical ordering. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Canonical ordering is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with comments policy is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for canonical ordering; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep comments policy behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Human", "HumanReadableProject");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and canonical ordering.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Memory strategy: comments policy

This page defines the memory strategy for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to comments policy. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Comments policy is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with round trips is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for comments policy; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep round trips behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HumanReadableProjectService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HumanReadableProjectConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HumanReadableProjectState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and comments policy.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Failure handling: round trips

This page defines the failure handling for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to round trips. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Round trips is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with diff friendliness is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for round trips; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep diff friendliness behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Human", "HumanReadableProject");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and round trips.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Diagnostics: diff friendliness

This page defines the diagnostics for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to diff friendliness. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Diff friendliness is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with canonical ordering is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for diff friendliness; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep canonical ordering behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HumanReadableProjectService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HumanReadableProjectConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HumanReadableProjectState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and diff friendliness.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.09 Human-readable project formats

Implementation sequence: canonical ordering

This page defines the implementation sequence for Human-readable project formats, with particular attention to canonical ordering. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Canonical ordering is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with comments policy is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for canonical ordering; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep comments policy behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Human", "HumanReadableProject");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.09 and canonical ordering.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Purpose and boundary: version graph

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to version graph. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Version graph is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with migrators is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for version graph; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep migrators behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SchemaVersionsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SchemaVersionsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SchemaVersionsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and version graph.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Architecture: migrators

This page defines the architecture for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to migrators. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Migrators is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deprecated fields is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for migrators; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deprecated fields behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Schema", "SchemaVersionsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and migrators.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Data model: deprecated fields

This page defines the data model for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to deprecated fields. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Deprecated fields is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with compatibility tests is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deprecated fields; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep compatibility tests behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SchemaVersionsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SchemaVersionsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SchemaVersionsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and deprecated fields.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Public API: compatibility tests

This page defines the public api for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to compatibility tests. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Compatibility tests is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with rollback is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compatibility tests; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep rollback behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Schema", "SchemaVersionsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and compatibility tests.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Ownership and lifetime: rollback

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to rollback. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Rollback is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with version graph is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for rollback; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep version graph behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SchemaVersionsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SchemaVersionsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SchemaVersionsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and rollback.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Threading model: version graph

This page defines the threading model for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to version graph. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Version graph is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with migrators is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for version graph; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep migrators behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Schema", "SchemaVersionsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and version graph.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Memory strategy: migrators

This page defines the memory strategy for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to migrators. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Migrators is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deprecated fields is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for migrators; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deprecated fields behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SchemaVersionsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SchemaVersionsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SchemaVersionsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and migrators.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Failure handling: deprecated fields

This page defines the failure handling for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to deprecated fields. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Deprecated fields is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with compatibility tests is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for deprecated fields; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep compatibility tests behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Schema", "SchemaVersionsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and deprecated fields.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Diagnostics: compatibility tests

This page defines the diagnostics for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to compatibility tests. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Compatibility tests is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with rollback is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compatibility tests; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep rollback behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SchemaVersionsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SchemaVersionsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SchemaVersionsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and compatibility tests.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Implementation sequence: rollback

This page defines the implementation sequence for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to rollback. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Rollback is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with version graph is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for rollback; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep version graph behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Schema", "SchemaVersionsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and rollback.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Verification: version graph

This page defines the verification for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to version graph. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Version graph is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with migrators is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for version graph; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep migrators behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SchemaVersionsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SchemaVersionsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SchemaVersionsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and version graph.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.10 Schema versions and migration

Completion gate: migrators

This page defines the completion gate for Schema versions and migration, with particular attention to migrators. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Migrators is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with deprecated fields is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for migrators; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep deprecated fields behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Schema", "SchemaVersionsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.10 and migrators.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Purpose and boundary: asset refs

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Reference serialization, with particular attention to asset refs. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Asset refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for asset refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReferenceSerializationService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReferenceSerializationConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReferenceSerializationState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and asset refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Architecture: object refs

This page defines the architecture for Reference serialization, with particular attention to object refs. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Object refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cross-scene refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cross-scene refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reference", "ReferenceSerialization");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and object refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Data model: cross-scene refs

This page defines the data model for Reference serialization, with particular attention to cross-scene refs. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Cross-scene refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with soft refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cross-scene refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep soft refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReferenceSerializationService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReferenceSerializationConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReferenceSerializationState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and cross-scene refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Public API: soft refs

This page defines the public api for Reference serialization, with particular attention to soft refs. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Soft refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with missing targets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for soft refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep missing targets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reference", "ReferenceSerialization");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and soft refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Ownership and lifetime: missing targets

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Reference serialization, with particular attention to missing targets. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Missing targets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with asset refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for missing targets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep asset refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReferenceSerializationService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReferenceSerializationConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReferenceSerializationState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and missing targets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Threading model: asset refs

This page defines the threading model for Reference serialization, with particular attention to asset refs. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Asset refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for asset refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reference", "ReferenceSerialization");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and asset refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Memory strategy: object refs

This page defines the memory strategy for Reference serialization, with particular attention to object refs. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Object refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cross-scene refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cross-scene refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReferenceSerializationService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReferenceSerializationConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReferenceSerializationState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and object refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Failure handling: cross-scene refs

This page defines the failure handling for Reference serialization, with particular attention to cross-scene refs. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Cross-scene refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with soft refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cross-scene refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep soft refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reference", "ReferenceSerialization");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and cross-scene refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Diagnostics: soft refs

This page defines the diagnostics for Reference serialization, with particular attention to soft refs. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Soft refs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with missing targets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for soft refs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep missing targets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ReferenceSerializationService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ReferenceSerializationConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ReferenceSerializationState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and soft refs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.11 Reference serialization

Implementation sequence: missing targets

This page defines the implementation sequence for Reference serialization, with particular attention to missing targets. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Missing targets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with asset refs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for missing targets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep asset refs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Reference", "ReferenceSerialization");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.11 and missing targets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Purpose and boundary: command records

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to command records. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Command records is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object deltas is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for command records; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object deltas behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransactionsAndUndoService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransactionsAndUndoConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransactionsAndUndoState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and command records.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Architecture: object deltas

This page defines the architecture for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to object deltas. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Object deltas is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with merging is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object deltas; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep merging behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transactions", "TransactionsAndUndo");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and object deltas.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Data model: merging

This page defines the data model for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to merging. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Merging is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with memory budgets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for merging; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep memory budgets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransactionsAndUndoService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransactionsAndUndoConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransactionsAndUndoState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and merging.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Public API: memory budgets

This page defines the public api for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to memory budgets. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Memory budgets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin operations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for memory budgets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin operations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transactions", "TransactionsAndUndo");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and memory budgets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Ownership and lifetime: plugin operations

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to plugin operations. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Plugin operations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with command records is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for plugin operations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep command records behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransactionsAndUndoService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransactionsAndUndoConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransactionsAndUndoState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and plugin operations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Threading model: command records

This page defines the threading model for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to command records. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Command records is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object deltas is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for command records; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object deltas behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transactions", "TransactionsAndUndo");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and command records.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Memory strategy: object deltas

This page defines the memory strategy for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to object deltas. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Object deltas is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with merging is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object deltas; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep merging behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransactionsAndUndoService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransactionsAndUndoConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransactionsAndUndoState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and object deltas.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Failure handling: merging

This page defines the failure handling for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to merging. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Merging is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with memory budgets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for merging; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep memory budgets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transactions", "TransactionsAndUndo");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and merging.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Diagnostics: memory budgets

This page defines the diagnostics for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to memory budgets. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Memory budgets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin operations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for memory budgets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin operations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransactionsAndUndoService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransactionsAndUndoConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransactionsAndUndoState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and memory budgets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Implementation sequence: plugin operations

This page defines the implementation sequence for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to plugin operations. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Plugin operations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with command records is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for plugin operations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep command records behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transactions", "TransactionsAndUndo");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and plugin operations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Verification: command records

This page defines the verification for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to command records. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Command records is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with object deltas is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for command records; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep object deltas behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransactionsAndUndoService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransactionsAndUndoConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransactionsAndUndoState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and command records.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.12 Transactions and undo/redo

Completion gate: object deltas

This page defines the completion gate for Transactions and undo/redo, with particular attention to object deltas. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Object deltas is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with merging is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for object deltas; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep merging behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transactions", "TransactionsAndUndo");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.12 and object deltas.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Purpose and boundary: base prefab

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to base prefab. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Base prefab is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overrides is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for base prefab; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overrides behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PrefabDataContractsService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PrefabDataContractsConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PrefabDataContractsState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and base prefab.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Architecture: overrides

This page defines the architecture for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to overrides. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Overrides is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with nested instances is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overrides; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep nested instances behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Prefab", "PrefabDataContracts");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and overrides.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Data model: nested instances

This page defines the data model for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to nested instances. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Nested instances is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with variants is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for nested instances; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep variants behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PrefabDataContractsService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PrefabDataContractsConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PrefabDataContractsState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and nested instances.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Public API: variants

This page defines the public api for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to variants. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Variants is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with conflict diagnostics is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for variants; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep conflict diagnostics behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Prefab", "PrefabDataContracts");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and variants.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Ownership and lifetime: conflict diagnostics

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to conflict diagnostics. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Conflict diagnostics is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with base prefab is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for conflict diagnostics; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep base prefab behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PrefabDataContractsService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PrefabDataContractsConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PrefabDataContractsState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and conflict diagnostics.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Threading model: base prefab

This page defines the threading model for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to base prefab. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Base prefab is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overrides is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for base prefab; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overrides behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Prefab", "PrefabDataContracts");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and base prefab.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Memory strategy: overrides

This page defines the memory strategy for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to overrides. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Overrides is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with nested instances is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overrides; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep nested instances behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PrefabDataContractsService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PrefabDataContractsConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PrefabDataContractsState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and overrides.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Failure handling: nested instances

This page defines the failure handling for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to nested instances. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Nested instances is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with variants is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for nested instances; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep variants behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Prefab", "PrefabDataContracts");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and nested instances.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Diagnostics: variants

This page defines the diagnostics for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to variants. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Variants is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with conflict diagnostics is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for variants; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep conflict diagnostics behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PrefabDataContractsService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PrefabDataContractsConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PrefabDataContractsState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and variants.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.13 Prefab data contracts

Implementation sequence: conflict diagnostics

This page defines the implementation sequence for Prefab data contracts, with particular attention to conflict diagnostics. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Conflict diagnostics is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with base prefab is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for conflict diagnostics; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep base prefab behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Prefab", "PrefabDataContracts");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.13 and conflict diagnostics.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Purpose and boundary: golden files

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to golden files. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Golden files is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with fuzzing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for golden files; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep fuzzing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PersistenceTestsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PersistenceTestsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PersistenceTestsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and golden files.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Architecture: fuzzing

This page defines the architecture for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to fuzzing. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Fuzzing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with corruption is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for fuzzing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep corruption behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Persistence", "PersistenceTestsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and fuzzing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Data model: corruption

This page defines the data model for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to corruption. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Corruption is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with migration matrix is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for corruption; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep migration matrix behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PersistenceTestsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PersistenceTestsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PersistenceTestsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and corruption.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Public API: migration matrix

This page defines the public api for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to migration matrix. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Migration matrix is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with performance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for migration matrix; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep performance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Persistence", "PersistenceTestsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and migration matrix.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Ownership and lifetime: performance

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to performance. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Performance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with golden files is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for performance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep golden files behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PersistenceTestsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PersistenceTestsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PersistenceTestsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and performance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Threading model: golden files

This page defines the threading model for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to golden files. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Golden files is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with fuzzing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for golden files; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep fuzzing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Persistence", "PersistenceTestsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and golden files.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Memory strategy: fuzzing

This page defines the memory strategy for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to fuzzing. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Fuzzing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with corruption is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for fuzzing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep corruption behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PersistenceTestsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PersistenceTestsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PersistenceTestsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and fuzzing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

02.14 Persistence tests and completion gate

Failure handling: corruption

This page defines the failure handling for Persistence tests and completion gate, with particular attention to corruption. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Corruption is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with migration matrix is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for corruption; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep migration matrix behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Persistence", "PersistenceTestsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 02.14 and corruption.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.